Same website. Different page. Your data is still there.'

How Websites Store and Retrieve Your Data



You type. The website listens. It saves your data, and when you come back, it finds it again — all in a few simple steps.

1 You interact with a website

You fill a form, click a button or log in. The data you enter is sent to the server using HTTP (usually in a form or an API).



HTTP Request (POST/GET)

Your browser sends the data.

2 PHP handles the request

The web server (Apache/Nginx) runs a PHP script. PHP reads your input, connects to the database using MySQL, and processes the data.

```php
<?php
$host = "localhost";
$user = "root";
$pass = "";
$db   = "studenthub";

$conn = new mysqli($host, $user, $pass, $db);

if ($conn->connect_error) {
    die("Connection failed: " . $conn->connect_error);
}
// Get data
$email = $_POST['email'];
```

Query (SELECT / INSERT / UPDATE / DELETE)

PHP processes your request.

3 MySQL stores your data

The data is saved in tables inside a MySQL database. MySQL keeps it organized, safe and fast to search.



Example: users table

id	name	email	password
1	Prey Patel	prey@email.com	********
2	Aditi Shah	aditi@email.com	********
3	Rohan Mehta	rohan@email.com	********

Data is saved in tables.

4 PHP gets the data back

When you visit again, PHP runs a query, fetches the data from MySQL and sends it to the browser (usually as HTML or JSON).

```php
<?php
$result = $conn->query("SELECT * FROM users
          WHERE email='".$email."'");

if ($result->num_rows > 0) {
   $user = $result->fetch_assoc();
   echo json_encode($user);
}
```

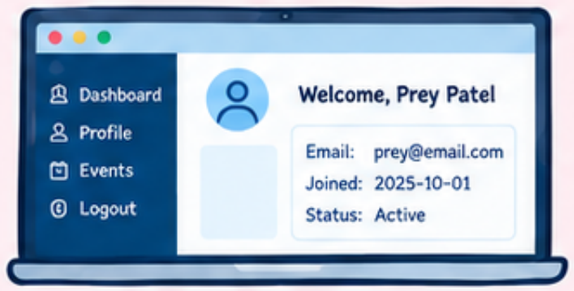
Fetch data from database

Return data (HTML / JSON)



5 You see your data

The browser receives the response and shows it to you — like your profile, dashboard or a list of items.



HTTP Response (HTML / JSON)

The data is sent back as HTML, JSON or both.

The Complete Flow

- **You (Browser)** — Fill form / click / log in
- **Web Server** (Apache / Nginx) — Runs PHP script
- **PHP** — Processes the request and talks to MySQL
- **MySQL** — Stores / retrieves data
- **Response** (HTML / JSON) — Goes back to your browser

Key Points

- ✓ You enter data in a website (form, login, etc.).
- ✓ PHP processes it on the server.
- ✓ MySQL stores it in tables.
- ✓ PHP fetches the data when needed.
- ✓ The website shows it back to you.

In Short

You type → PHP → MySQL → You see it

Same data. Different page. Same process.